

Samsung SDI Co. (006400.KS): Core OP in line; AI infra batteries gain momentum

Samsung SDI (SDI) posted strong revenue growth (+19% YoY) and returned to operating profit of ₩204bn in 2Q26, following six consecutive loss-making quarters. Results included a one-off tariff refund of ~₩200bn relating to duties paid last year; excluding this, operating profit was near Bloomberg consensus (~₩13bn). Key takeaways from the analyst call:

Turnaround to be gradual and led by small cylindrical battery. UPS and BBU battery revenue are each guided to grow more than 70% YoY in 2026 with c.40-50% market share, and existing high-power cylindrical lines are running at full capacity with expansion planned; qualification barriers around instantaneous high-power output and safety supports higher profitability than other product categories.

US ESS order book extends through 2029 and points to a capacity constraint from 2028. Secured orders cover a substantial portion of capacity through 2029 and, including projects with a high likelihood of award in 2H26, demand is expected to exceed production capacity from 2028, with options to secure additional capacity under review; this compares with 2-3 years of local US capacity coverage guided at 1Q26.

EV recovery is Europe-led, with further order wins guided within the year. xEV losses are expected to narrow as volume models that entered mass production in 2Q26 ramp, though volume declines in existing projects were flagged as a risk. SDI is in discussion with multiple European OEMs off a prismatic lineup now spanning high-nickel, mid-nickel and LFP, and expects additional orders within the year following the Mercedes-Benz win in April.

Technology roadmap intact, with humanoid sequenced ahead of EV for all-solid-state. The 2H27 all-solid-state mass production target was maintained, with humanoid likely the first commercial application, samples due in 2H26, while EV development runs in parallel for expansion thereafter. Near term, the US prismatic LFP for ESS begins cell production in October with SBB 2.0 deliveries within the year; sodium-ion UPS and utility ESS solutions are in development with mass production lines being prepared, and SDI won its first project applying cylindrical batteries to HEV.

Key upside/downside risks: (1) Higher/lower-than-expected global EV penetration rate growth; (2) faster/slower-than-expected EV/ESS shipment and market share growth in battery-related business; (3) higher/lower-than-expected battery business margins, higher/lower-than-expected EM business margins; (4)

Nikhil Bhandari
+65-6889-2867 |
nikhil.bhandari@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Singapore) Pte

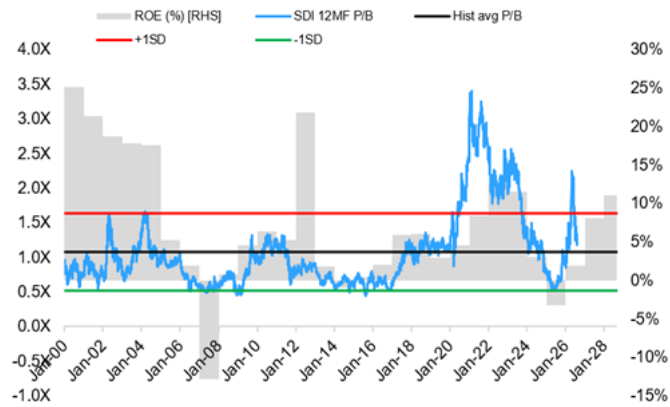
Giuni Lee
+82(2)3788-1177 | giuni.lee@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C., Seoul
Branch

John Tsang
+65-6654-5454 | john.tsang@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Singapore) Pte

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weaker/stronger-than-expected KRW:USD.

Exhibit 1: Samsung SDI 12M Fwd P/B vs ROE trend



Source: Refinitiv Eikon, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Investment Thesis – Samsung SDI

Samsung SDI (SDI) is a battery and electronic materials manufacturer maintaining industry-leading profitability levels in the large-sized battery business while becoming more of a pure-play battery company. We expect Samsung SDI battery margins to be more resilient than that of peers given long-term contracts with premium customers. Meanwhile, SDI is making good progress on technology leadership (alongside LGES) with strong know-how and a diversified new product offering (mass production of prismatic P6 with Ni >90%, cylindrical 46-pi, and solid state batteries). We also see potential for further cell order momentum in the US market as OEMs look for battery suppliers and form factor diversification.

While we remain positive on SDI's fundamentals, the stock is now already pricing in our base case xEV long-term market share and core xEV EBITDA margin growth; as well as our base case ESS assumptions. The stock is also trading above its long-term average 12m forward P/B multiple. We are Neutral rated on the stock.

Price Target Risks and Methodology – Samsung SDI Co.

We are Neutral rated on Samsung SDI with a 2027E/28E SOTP-based 12m TP of W695,000 (xEV Battery: DCF; Small-size Battery/ESS/EM: 11x/14x/8x 27E/28E EBITDA multiple; Listed/unlisted subsidiaries: market/book value).

Key upside/downside risks:

(1) Higher/lower-than-expected global EV penetration rate growth; (2) faster/slower-than-expected EV/ESS shipment and market share growth in battery-related business; (3) higher/lower-than-expected battery business margins, higher/lower-than-expected EM business margins and; (4) weaker/stronger-than-expected KRW:USD.

006400.KS	12m Price Target: W695,000	Price: W358,500	Upside: 93.9%		
Neutral	GS Forecast				
Market cap: W24.0tr / \$16.6bn Enterprise value: W32.2tr / \$22.3bn 3m ADTV: W349.1bn / \$232.1mn South Korea Korea EV Battery M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	Revenue (W bn)	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	EBITDA (W bn)	13,266.7	15,732.7	24,143.5	31,838.1
	EPS (W)	380.6	2,438.3	4,684.2	6,290.3
	P/E (X)	(8,253)	5,227	23,551	35,477
	P/B (X)	NM	68.6	15.2	10.1
	Dividend yield (%)	0.7	1.2	1.1	1.0
	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
	CROCI (%)	23.9	3.4	1.7	1.0
	FCF yield (%)	2.0	3.9	6.5	7.9
		(14.6)	(0.8)	(1.6)	2.6
		3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
	EPS (W)	(356)	487	2,179	2,917

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 30 Jul 2026 close.

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Reg AC

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Contributing Authors: Nikhil Bhandari Goldman Sachs (Singapore) Pte, Giuni Lee Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C., Seoul Branch, John Tsang Goldman Sachs (Singapore) Pte.

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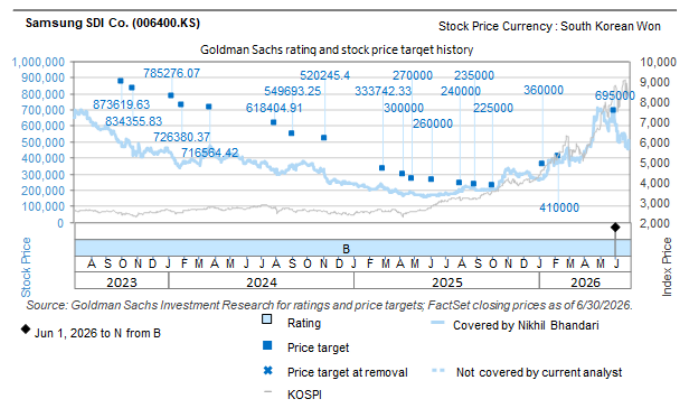
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

Samsung SDI Co. (006400.KS)

Date of report Target price (W) Closing price (W)

01-Jun-26	695,000	652,000
11-Feb-26	410,000	377,000
11-Jan-26	360,000	267,500
03-Oct-25	225,000	206,500
28-Aug-25	235,000	216,000
31-Jul-25	240,000	201,000
08-Jun-25	260,000	174,300
27-Apr-25	270,000	185,100
10-Apr-25	300,000	177,200
02-Mar-25	340,000	218,876
06-Nov-24	530,000	291,672
04-Sep-24	560,000	349,811
30-Jul-24	630,000	322,940
25-Mar-24	730,000	474,883
30-Jan-24	740,000	365,934
09-Jan-24	800,000	422,118
26-Oct-23	850,000	413,324
03-Oct-23	890,000	500,289

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